

Cursed Stone

Intro Scene

Property Of:
The Volto Corporation

The sun must have started its decent into the earth. The shadows have become longer with the only natural light remaining are on the steps of the alleyway.

It won't be long before the apothecary will be bathed in the light from the varying jars that hang from the ceiling. It always paints the room in vivid colours of distinct shades, the most prominent being purple.

It reminds me of Master's robes; I wonder if it's his favourite colour? I probably wouldn't get a straight answer if I asked.

The darkness would have brought noise as a distraction. Drunkards singing after being kicked out of the taverns, musicians playing their instruments as they danced through the streets, workers coming home from their gruelling labour.

Everything is just unnaturally quite, even my breathing sounds too loud. If I focused I'm sure I would be able to hear my own heartbeat.

Not even the knights are making their rounds in the darkened corners any more.

[[I prefer the quite.]] – set quite true

I've never enjoyed the noise. I was most at peace during the time I lived in the forest. There were no merchants yelling, drunkards staring brawls or rowdy laughter from the many taverns in the area.

There wasn't any shepherds or knights. It was just nature and...us.

[[I miss the noise of the town.]] – set quite false

The town seems so empty now there aren't any minstrels singing while dancing down the streets or the bustle of the market of vendors promoting goods and people eager to buy. I'm even missing the laughter that escaped from the taverns.

At least there aren't as many knights or shepherds patrolling. I know for a fact they... would have loved this.

...

I wish both of them were here... that he was still...

The sound of rustling fabric and metal clinking against one another rips me back to reality. I haven't even noticed that the back-door had swung open.

My Master leans against the door frame of the workshop an amused grin plastered on his face. One hand twirls his pipe, blue smoke leisurely seeping out of the carved wood. The other fiddles with the fabric of his robes, picking at not existent loose strands.

"Oh my how can my dutiful apprentice be half asleep at the counter? Who will attend our numerous patrons now?"

He pats my head as he walks past me, chuckling under his breath. He begins to move between the various hanging jars resting his fingers at the bottom and lighting each one.

There hasn't been a patron for a couple of hours, and it will be reasonable to presume that there won't be any more for tonight.

Only the truly desperate would come knocking at this hour.

[[I slump onto the counter.]] set lazy true
My cheek is squished against forcing my eyes to squint. I can only see the way my Master's robes sway with his movements.

He's humming a familiar tune, the one he hums when he's closing or opening the apothecary.

There weren't a lot of customers but I still feel tired. I really don't want to clean the mess he's most surely made in the workshop.

[[I start to tidy up the shop.]] set lazy false
I grab the broom that lies on the wall behind me and begin to sweep at the entrance. My master glances at me with a soft smile before returning to the task he's doing.

He starts to hum a familiar tune, one that he always hums before we open or close the apothecary.